DESIGN CAPSULE · INDIA 2026–28

# Design Capsule: Indian craft goes global

Kolhapuris on the Prada runway, mirror work, Rabari and kantha embroidery, block prints and bandhani.

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# Mood and colour

| | |
|---|---|
| Rust<br>18-1248 TCX<br>#B5522B | Indigo<br>19-3864 TCX<br>#2F3F7A |
| Champagne gold<br>14-0935 TCX<br>#D8C08A | Ivory<br>11-0104 TCX<br>#F3ECDC |

Pantone TCX (cotton) codes are the nearest match to the screen colour; confirm against a physical Pantone book and lab dips before production.

**Why?** The Kolhapuri debate made Indian shoppers proud of the original crafts. GI-tagged and artisan-made products now carry real brand value.

**What?** Indian crafts are in the global spotlight. Prada showed Kolhapuri-inspired sandals in 7 of 56 Spring/Summer 2026 looks, Rabari embroidery reached the Indian runway, and kantha is moving onto sneakers.

**Who's showing it?**

- **Prada (Spring/Summer 2026):** Kolhapuri-inspired sandals in 7 of 56 looks
- **Kartik Research:** Rabari embroidery on handspun khadi
- **Gully Labs:** Sneakers with kantha embroidery and Indian colour stories

# Key pieces

The key pieces with reference photos, ready to brief into design.



## Kolhapuri chappals

RISING

GI-tagged Kolhapuris, back in focus after Prada's Spring/Summer 2026 show.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 | Summer 28 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Rising | Peaking | Peaking | Peaking |

| Festive 28 |
|---|
| Fading |



## Mirror work

RISING

Mirror work on garments, dupattas, bags and shoes.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 | Summer 28 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Rising | Peaking | Peaking | Peaking |

| Festive 28 |
|---|
| Fading |



## Rabari embroidery

EMERGING

Kutch Rabari embroidery, shown by Kartik Research.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 | Summer 28 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Emerging | Rising | Rising | Peaking |

| Festive 28 |
|---|
| Peaking |



## Kantha-embroidered sneakers

EMERGING

Suede sneakers with kantha embroidery.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 | Summer 28 | Festive 28 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Emerging | Rising | Rising | Peaking | Peaking |



## Bandhani

RISING

Tie-dye dots from Gujarat and Rajasthan.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 | Summer 28 | Festive 28 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Rising | Rising | Peaking | Peaking | Fading |



## Embellished wedding juttis

PEAKING

Juttis with zari, beads and mirror work for weddings.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 | Summer 28 | Festive 28 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Peaking | Peaking | Peaking | Peaking | Peaking |

# Price guide (India)

| KEY GARMENT | VALUE | MID | PREMIUM |
|---|---|---|---|
| Kolhapuri chappals | ₹499–1,299 | ₹1,500–3,500 | ₹6,000+ |
| Mirror-work kurta or jacket | ₹1,299–2,499 | ₹3,000–7,000 | ₹15,000+ |
| Embroidered juttis | ₹799–1,499 | ₹1,800–4,000 | ₹7,500+ |

Cost to make: Medium. Hand embroidery is labour-heavy. Use placement embroidery and partner with clusters for authentic GI-tagged pieces.

## How to build the capsule

- Source one GI-tagged hero product and credit the craft cluster.
- Add mirror or kantha accents to everyday basics.
- Pair Kolhapuris and juttis with western looks in imagery.

## Range plan

Use Indian embroidery and textiles on silhouettes that travel: shirts, jackets, dresses and trousers. Explain the craft clearly for customers who may not know it.

- **Hero pieces (about 20%):** the strongest expression of the story, at higher prices.
- **Core pieces (about 60%):** easy-to-wear styles in the capsule colours.
- **Add-ons (about 20%):** accessories and layers that increase basket size.

## Selling it in different regions

In India, time the capsule to the festive or summer window it suits. For South Asian communities abroad, link it to local festival dates and weddings. For international customers new to Indian fashion, lead with easy pieces such as shirts, jackets and scarves, and explain the craft.

## Common questions

**Why is Indian craft going global?** Luxury brands and Indian couturiers on international calendars have raised awareness of techniques such as zardozi and chikankari.

**How do I price craft for export?** Include hand-work time, quality control and documentation costs, and position the product as premium.

Sources: Global Indian on Prada SS26; Free Press Journal, Lakmé Fashion Week 2026; Gully Labs.